



Office of
Deputy Commissioner
of Maritime Affairs

THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA LIBERIA MARITIME AUTHORITY

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TECHNICAL LETTER 2025-02 05 September 2025

Subject: Location of Fuel Isolation Valves as a Measure to Control Fires in Engine Rooms

Ref: a. SOLAS Ch. II-2, Regulation 4.2.2.5.5
b. MSC.1/Circ.1321, Part III, Chapter 4.2
c. MSC.1/Circ.1321 Compliance Checklist
d. Marine Advisory: 31/2024

Further to the Administration's SAFETY ALERT 1-2017, dated 8 February 2017, recent port state activity has focused again, including as noted in reference (d), on vessel compliance with SOLAS regulation II-2/4.2.2.5.5 which provides that multi-engine installations supplied from the same fuel source shall be provided with a means of isolating the fuel supplied to individual engines and shall be operable from a position not rendered inaccessible by a fire on any of the engines.

Whilst the regulation 4.2.2.5.5 of SOLAS II-2 regarding multi-engine isolation valves applies to ships with keel laid date on or after 1 July 2002; in 2009, the IMO Maritime Safety Committee approved **MSC.1/Circ.1321**, providing additional guidance to ensure uniform and harmonized application of this SOLAS regulation and minimize deviation of interpretation among shipowners, ship designers, inspectors, surveyors and governments.

MSC.1/Circ.1321 provides that, where possible, the fuel oil isolation valves should be:

- a. located at least 5 meters away from engines in any direction or
- b. the operating position of the valves should be protected by an obstruction or
- c. operated remotely from a protected location.

For all ships with keel laid date on or after 1 July 2002, we recommend using the attached checklist, reference (c), to review the arrangements on board your vessels. If you find one of your vessels is not in compliance with the above, please contact us with a corrective action plan, and we will work with you to ensure compliance.

If you have any questions on this Technical Letter, please contact Regsandstandards@liscr.com.

Regards,

Peter Zavorskas

Peter Zavorskas
For the Deputy Commissioner of
Maritime Affairs

Republic of Liberia

MSC.1/Circ.1321 Compliance Checklist

Name of Ship:

IMO Number:

Owner/Operator:

Classification Society:

1. Is each individual engine supplied from the same fuel source?

YES NO (If NO, nothing further needs to be done)

2. Is there a means of isolating the fuel supply and spill piping to each individual engine?

YES NO

3. Are the fuel oil isolating valves located at least 5 m away from engines in any direction?

YES NO

4. For valves located less than 5m from the engine is the operating position protected by an obstruction? YES NO

Describe the obstruction:

5. Are remotely controlled fuel oil shutoff/isolating valves installed? YES NO

6. Are remotely controlled fuel oil shutoff/isolating valves protected from fire? YES NO

7. Are other means of protection capable of enabling access to the isolating valves in the event of a fire provided?

YES NO

Describe the alternate means:
